

Frequency Check

SUMMIT TUITION · LUPIN · ONE-TO-ONE

Name: **Lupin**Date: **9 August 2026**Time: **≈ 25 min, 1 min per mark**Marks: **___ / 22**

Frequency Check

Apply the answer structures from your walkthrough sheet to every question below — check the mark count before you write.

Mia had checked the running order twice already, but she checked it a third time anyway, because the alternative was sitting still with the thought that kept circling back: the recording on the desk wasn't the one she remembered making. Radio club went live at four, and it was eleven minutes to.

"Two minutes to headphones on," said Dev, not looking up from the desk where he was arranging cue cards into an order only he understood. Dev had joined the club in September, six months after Mia, and still treated the studio like something that might ask him to leave if he touched the wrong dial. Mia hadn't corrected that impression, because it meant he double-checked everything, which was usually useful. Today it wasn't going to save her.

She opened the playlist folder again. There it was, labelled exactly as it should be — the opening jingle Mr Whitfield had approved on Tuesday, after she'd recorded it four times to get it right. Except when she clicked it, what played back was a half-finished loop from her very first attempt, her own voice still testing sound levels underneath it. Somewhere between Tuesday and now, someone — herself, probably, in a hurry — had saved the wrong recording under the right name.

Dev noticed her face before she said anything. "What."

"Nothing." The word was out before she'd decided to say it. She could re-record something rough in the next ten minutes, something that would pass if nobody listened too closely, and nobody would need to know the approved version had gone missing. Or she could tell Mr Whitfield now, with the studio door still open and eight minutes on the clock, and watch him decide whether four months of Friday broadcasts had taught her anything about handling a mistake.

Dev was still watching her. "You've gone the colour of the mixing desk."

She thought about that very first recording — her own voice, unpolished, checking levels, never meant for broadcast. Then she thought about what Mr Whitfield always said before every show: *a broadcast with a flaw somebody flags beats a broadcast with a flaw nobody catches until it's live*. She hadn't really believed him until this exact moment, with the wrong recording open and the clock somehow now reading six minutes.

"Actually," Mia said, already standing, "I need to find Mr Whitfield." Dev's cue cards stayed exactly where they were, forgotten, as she went.

SECTION A — ANSWER IN FULL SENTENCES WHERE APPROPRIATE. CHECK THE MARKS BEFORE YOU WRITE.

1 — Retrieval (1 MARK)

What did Mia discover when she clicked on the jingle file?

2 (2 MARKS)

Give two details from the passage which show that Dev is still getting used to the studio.

3 — Retrieval (1 MARK)

What time was radio club due to go live?

4 (1 MARK)

Give a piece of evidence that Mia is trying to hide her worry from Dev.

5 — In your own words (1 MARK)

Explain in your own words why Mia says "Nothing" when Dev asks what's wrong.

6 — Vocabulary in context (2 MARKS)

What do the following words mean, as used in the passage?

circling (paragraph 1)

forgotten (final paragraph)

7 (3 MARKS)

Look again at "You've gone the colour of the mixing desk." Explain what this suggests about Mia at that moment.

8 (4 MARKS)

Find two quotations from the extract which show Mia's growing anxiety. Explain the effect of each.

9 (4 MARKS)

How does the writer use language and structure to build tension across the extract as a whole? Use quotations to help you answer.

10 (3 MARKS)

Give three quotations from any part of the extract which reveal Mia's character. Use the details you have chosen to explain what they reveal.

MODEL ANSWERS & MARK SCHEME — MARK YOURSELF HONESTLY BEFORE
YOUR SESSION

Question style and mark allocation checked against real Latymer School and Dame Alice Owen's School specimen English papers (see tutor notes) — this is not a copy of either school's actual passage or questions.

Q1 — RETRIEVAL (1 MARK)

- ✓ Instead of the approved jingle, the recording was a half-finished loop from her first attempt, with her own voice still testing sound levels underneath it.

Q2 (2 MARKS — 1 PER DETAIL)

- ✓ **Detail 1:** he still treats the studio "like something that might ask him to leave if he touched the wrong dial."
- ✓ **Detail 2:** he had joined the club six months after Mia / he double-checks everything.

Q3 — RETRIEVAL (1 MARK)

- ✓ Four o'clock.

Q4 (1 MARK)

- ✓ She says "Nothing" to Dev / the word was out before she'd decided to say it, even though something was clearly wrong.

Q5 — IN YOUR OWN WORDS (1 MARK)

Sample answer: "She hides the problem without really meaning to — the denial comes out automatically, before she's actually decided what to say."

Check: did you avoid lifting "the word was out before she'd decided to say it" word-for-word? That exact phrase scores zero.

Q6 — VOCABULARY IN CONTEXT (2 MARKS — 1 PER WORD)

- ✓ **circling:** going round and round repeatedly, without stopping — suggesting a worry she can't switch off.
- ✓ **forgotten:** no longer being thought about or attended to — here, Dev's cue cards, because Mia's focus has shifted entirely to what she's about to do.

Q7 (3 MARKS — 1 FOR IDENTIFYING THE EVIDENCE, 2 FOR EXPLAINING THE EFFECT)

- ✓ **Evidence (1):** Dev's outside observation that Mia has "gone the colour of the mixing desk."
- ✓ **Effect (2):** this shows that Mia's panic, which she is trying to hide, has become visible to someone else — confirming to the reader that her internal anxiety is now serious enough to show physically, not just something she's privately worrying about.

Q8 (4 MARKS — 2 MARKS PER QUOTATION + EFFECT)

- ✓ **Quotation 1 (2):** "the thought that kept circling back" — the repetition suggested by "circling" creates an impression of a worry Mia cannot switch off, rather than a single passing doubt.
- ✓ **Quotation 2 (2):** "she checked it a third time anyway" — checking three times, rather than stopping at once, shows her anxiety through her actions rather than by simply being told she is anxious.

Q9 (4 MARKS, INDICATIVE CONTENT)

- ✓ **Point 1:** the writer opens with Mia's anxious triple-checking before revealing why, so the reader shares her unease before understanding its cause.
- ✓ **Point 2:** the exact nature of the problem is withheld until the third paragraph, building curiosity in the opening lines.
- ✓ **Point 3:** the countdown detail (eleven minutes, then eight, then six) is dropped in gradually across the extract, creating a ticking-clock urgency that intensifies as it goes on.
- ✓ **Point 4:** the short, clipped dialogue ("What." / "Nothing.") speeds up the pace at exactly the tensest moment, mirroring Mia's racing thoughts.
- ✓ (Full marks require four clearly explained points, each linked to a quotation — reward any well-evidenced point in this spirit, not only these four.)

Q10 (3 MARKS — 1 PER QUOTATION, EXPLAINED)

- ✓ **Quotation 1:** she checks the running order "a third time anyway" — reveals she is conscientious, taking her responsibilities seriously even under pressure.
- ✓ **Quotation 2:** "The word was out before she'd decided to say it" — reveals her first instinct under pressure is to protect herself, not admit the mistake.
- ✓ **Quotation 3:** "I need to find Mr Whitfield" — reveals that, in the end, her honesty wins out over her instinct to hide the problem.